



# Setting Up Your Workspace

**No matter where you base your business, planning and organizing your workspace will improve your efficiency, productivity, and well-being, as well as minimize risks to health and safety.**

## Assessing your needs

A successful workspace is one that allows your business to operate effectively while also ensuring that your needs and those of your staff, clients, and customers are met. These needs will depend on the nature of the business—the ideal workspace for a car mechanic is very different from that of an accountant working at home. In each case, however, a well-designed workspace that functions efficiently can help reduce

accidents and illness or stress-related problems while increasing productivity and well-being (see pp.172–173).

When planning your workspace, consider who will be using it and the tasks they will be performing, ensuring that furnishings are appropriate and that devices and facilities are easy to use and fit for purpose. Importantly, check that your workspace is in line with any relevant health and safety regulations (see pp.212–215).

## The basics

A business that takes care of employee needs by providing comfortable and safe working conditions—from equipment to temperature—will enjoy higher productivity and fewer days lost to absenteeism. Although employees' specific needs will vary according to the type of work they perform, there are some basic requirements that are common to most workplaces.

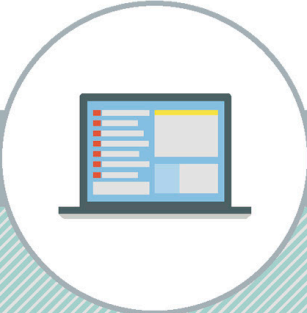
**55%**  
of typical employees spend the majority of their time away from their desks

iofficecorp.com, 2020

## CALCULATING SPACE REQUIREMENTS

Buying or renting workspace is a major cost, so you will want to use your space optimally. The typical allowance per desk worker can vary from 50–100 sq ft (4.5–9 sq m) and will include height as well as floor area, but check local regulations. There are many free online tools to help you calculate your space

requirements. When calculating your needs, take into account space for people to circulate and any unusable areas that are awkwardly shaped or poorly lit. Open-plan designs in which people share facilities can save on space but will not suit all types of businesses. Also allow space for additional staff down the line.



### IT EQUIPMENT

Virtually every business requires a computer, if not several, together with a Wi-Fi or wired connection. You may also need printers, which in turn require space to store paper and ink. Check that your workspace has enough electrical sockets for equipment and that they are located near workstations.